

Aboriginal Studies 30



Urbanization and its Effects – Leah Dorion

<http://interactive-learning-objects.onlea.org/mapping/#/painting/painting-4>

Theme 4

Aboriginal World Issues & Novel Study

Resources Required:

- Aboriginal Studies 30 Textbook: *Contemporary Issues*
- Film: *Rabbit Proof Fence*

Tawaw (Cree for welcome)

It is important to take a moment to recognize Elk Island Public School Division respectfully acknowledges we are located on Treaty 6 territory, a traditional gathering place for diverse Indigenous peoples including the Cree, Blackfoot, Metis, Nakota Sioux, Iroquois, Dene, Ojibway/ Saulteaux/Anishinaabe, Inuit, and many others whose histories, languages, and cultures continue to influence our vibrant community.

Miigwetch (An Ojibway word for giving thanks)

Acknowledgment and Thanks

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WORLD ISSUES



Read pages 208-233 of your Contemporary Issues Textbook and answer the questions below.

An Interview with Rigoberta Menchu Tum (page 208-209)

1. Consider some of the connections between the situation of First Nations in Canada and in Guatemala.

a) Explain one similarity between the two groups. /2



b) Explain one difference between the two groups. /2

Common Cultures, Common Issues (page 210-219)

2. What does the word *indigenous* mean? /1



3. Where do most Indigenous people gain their cultural identity? /1

4. Drawing on what you know of First Nations in Canada, outline characteristics in common between Aboriginal cultures. /5

	Characteristics in Common
Spirituality and the Land	
Oral Traditions	
Extended Family	
Respect for Diversity	
Community	

Colonial History

5. What is ethnocentrism? /1



Common Issues

6. Drawing on what you know of First Nations in Canada, outline issues affecting Aboriginal cultures across the world. Give an example for each. /16

	Issues in Common
Land and Resources	
Environment	
War	
Language and Culture	
Education	
Self-Determination	
Health	
Human Rights	

We are now going to take a deep-dive into another country and their colonial history with the Indigenous People... Australia

In Aboriginal Studies 20 we discussed Canada's Residential School history and the intergenerational trauma still being felt today. Australia had similar schools for Indigenous Peoples, and it is important to take a look at the effects of colonization around the globe. First, let's take a look at some basic terminology for the Indigenous people of Australia.

What to say...Not to say



Talking terminology for **A**boriginal and **T**orres Strait Islander people

By Summer May Finlay

Summer May Finlay is a Yorta Yorta woman and grew up on Lake Macquarie.

Summer May Finlay notes that terms such as Abo and the acronym **ATSI** are offensive when referring to actual people. In Canada, some First Nations, Métis and Inuit community also object to the acronym **FNMI**.

7. Why do you think when referring to a PERSON you should NOT call them ATSI or FNMI? /2

Finlay also refers to a people known as Torres Strait Islanders. Geographically and culturally, they are separate from mainland Aboriginals of Australia. Note the map below:



Stolen Generation

Follow the link to view: A Look Inside the Heartbreaking Story of Australia's "Stolen Generation." Use this source to complete Assignment 4.1.

Fact Sheet Here

Read the Fact Sheet titled, *Stolen Generations and Canadian Residential Schools*.

There are some common experiences between the Canadian and Australian colonial experiences. While reading the fact sheet regarding Australia's Stolen Generation and

Canadian Residential Schools, please record point form notes on the following comparison chart. Also, use information from the 'Stolen Generation' video. You may conduct additional research as needed, but please be sure to copy the links to the source you used at the bottom of the assignment.

Assignment 4.1 CANADA'S RESIDENTIAL SCHOOLS & AUSTRALIA'S STOLEN GENERATION COMPARISON CHART

/24 Marks

Fill in the following chart. Remember to only include information that is connected to the topic. Focus on what is important.

CATEGORY	AUSTRALIA'S STOLEN GENERATIONS	CANADA'S RESIDENTIAL SCHOOLS
Main objective/goal of the Government. The government's rationale behind the creation of these policies/beliefs. Assimilation policies.		
After the children were forcibly removed from their homes, where did they go? How long were the children gone for?		
Describe the childrens' experiences.		
Impact on children, families, and communities. What did the children lose?		
Important reports.		

Outcomes of the reports.		
National apology date and its effects.		
Reconciliation and healing.		

8. Think back to Aboriginal Studies 20, what reasons do you think a colonizer would give for separating indigenous children from their families? Consider several factors, including the impacts this separation would have had on indigenous cultures. /3

<u>It's the Same Story</u>	Read the following article: <i>'It's the same story'</i> : How Australia and Canada are twinning on bad outcomes for Indigenous people
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English settler colonialism works in very similar ways. In Australia, Half-caste children (an outdated and inappropriate term referring to children of Aboriginal and settler descent) were extremely vulnerable because they were not completely accepted in black or white society. Decisions were made by government officials without any input from those involved. The film you are about to watch is based on a true story.

Film Study: *Rabbit Proof Fence*

Plot Summary: *Rabbit-Proof Fence* tells the story of three Australian Aboriginal girls – Molly Craig, Gracie Fields and Daisy Karnpill Craig – and their dramatic escape and walk home from the Moore River Native Settlement in the year 1931. Molly, the oldest of the three girls, organises to escape from Moore River with her sister and cousin.



The girls head north and, after getting some information from a woman who feeds them, are able to find the rabbit-proof fence which Molly knows will lead them home. The girls must walk 1,500 miles (2414 km) through difficult conditions. The girls are chased by Modoo, an Aboriginal Australian tracker, and by Constable Riggs. At the same time, women in their community in Jigalong are chanting and sending them strength. When the girls wake up in the desert, the spirit bird appears, and they find the strength to walk the rest of the way home.

When they arrive, they must immediately hide so that they are not recaptured. The film ends with images of the real-life Molly and Daisy walking in Jigalong. They say they will never go back to 'that place' – Moore River.

Watch the film via this link: [Rabbit Proof Fence](#)



Background pictures



While watching the film answer the following questions:

9. What are some similarities and differences between Australia and Canada's forced assimilation policies and beliefs. /5

10. Describe how you felt witnessing the girl's forceful removal. /4

11. Share examples of how Molly used her traditional knowledge to find her way over 1000 miles to get home. /2
12. Explain the role of the Aboriginal tracker and why he tracked students who ran away. /2
13. Discuss the extreme lengths Mr. Neville, aka the Devil, went to in order to find the girls. /3
14. Discuss how Molly and her daughter were impacted again and again. /3

The end of ***Rabbit-Proof Fence*** states:

Aboriginal children were forcibly removed from their families throughout Australia until 1970. Today many of these Aboriginal people continue to suffer from this destruction of identity, family life and culture. We call them the Stolen Generations.

The concept of the Stolen Generations is still controversial in Australia. Some Australians deny the idea, while others recognize it and agree that these children and their families suffered greatly. In 2008, the Australian government publicly acknowledged and apologized for the policies, which caused the Stolen Generations.



Assignment 4.2 RABBIT PROOF FENCE

Based on what you have watched and read...

- What is their opinion on the Stolen Generations?
- Why do they think some Australians deny the idea of the Stolen Generations?
- What do they think the impact of the Stolen Generations has been on the Australian Aboriginal community?

Respond in paragraph form (1-2 paragraphs) using the response criteria.

Type or write your response below

15. What is the connection between Hiroshima and the Dene people of Great Bear Lake? /2



Indigenous People and the Demand of Resources

16. What does the Rio Declaration of 1992 state? /2
17. What is the nature of the relationship between Syncrude and many of Canada's Aboriginal people? /2

United Nations (page 226-229)

18. What was the response of the Government of Canada to the UN Human Rights Committee report? /1

The Origins and Powers of the UN

19. What are the four main purposes of the United Nations? /4

Indigenous Peoples and the UN

20. How can the United Nations help indigenous Peoples in their causes? /4

Aboriginal Youth and Education (page 230-233)

The Importance of Education

21. True or False. Of the one hundred and thirty million children world-wide who do not finish school, the vast majority of them are Aboriginal.

/1

- a) True
- b) False

22. How does education make it easier for Aboriginal Peoples across the world to make their concerns heard? /2



A NOVEL STUDY

Halfbreed, by Maria Campbell

To read this novel you have some options:

- Borrow the book from our school library or your local library (come talk to me about this).
- If you have Spotify, you receive a certain amount of audiobook hours per month. Simply type the title and author into the search bar to begin listening.
- Use the digital copy on google classroom.

Introduction

- Maria Campbell is a Canadian Métis writer best known for her important memoir, *Half-breed*.
- She was made an Officer of the Order of Canada in 2008.
- Campbell was born in 1940 in northwestern Saskatchewan on a trapline and grew up in a road-allowance community.
- The oldest of eight children, the young Maria had to leave her one-room country school to care for the other children when her mother died.
- At fifteen she left home and went to Vancouver.
- In her twenties she returned to the Prairies and became a community worker and organizer.

Campbell overcame many difficulties to take control of her own life and to help her people. This journey of self-discovery is traced in *Half-breed* (1973), a moving account of a woman who struggled with poverty, alcoholism, drug addiction, sexual abuse and prostitution to reach thirty-three years of age and begin her healing process.

Campbell tells her story in the context of Métis culture and a forgotten history. She brings in myth and creates a distinctive voice for a people ignored by mainstream society. This book has been used as a text in countless university and college courses across North America and translated in Europe.

- Maria Campbell earned an M.A. in Native Studies from the University of Saskatchewan.
- She has received honorary doctorates from the University of Regina (1995), York University (1992) and Athabasca University (2000).
- She has taught Métis history and the study of oral traditions at universities in Saskatchewan, Manitoba and Alberta.

Clearly define each term in full sentences. (2 marks each)

Term	Definition
Road Allowance People	
Treaty Indians	
Mushoom	
Kokum	
Trappers	
Half-breed	

Half Breed is the true story of Maria Campbell. Each chapter Maria writes about experiences that shaped her life. After you read each chapter, what words/images/questions stood out to you and why? Each chapter is worth 2 marks.

Chapter	Words/Images/Questions	Why?
Intro		
1		
2		
3		
4		
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24		

Assignment 4.3 Personal Response

Based on what you have read and background knowledge...

Your final assignment for this novel will be to choose **ONE** of the following study questions and then 'discuss' your thoughts.

- At the time that this book was written Métis culture was not widely accepted in Canada. Summarize Maria's description of Halfbreed culture. Do some of your own research on Métis culture. Compare your research with Maria's description.
- Early in the book, Maria expresses a number of dreams for her family. What barriers does she encounter in trying to find those dreams?
- The law and the government, in theory, are there to work for the good of the people in a country. In Halfbreed, we see numerous examples of the government interfering in Halfbreed life to make it more difficult. Discuss one example from the book where the government and the law actually discriminate against Maria's family.
- Today many Aboriginal people are leaving their home communities in pursuit of economic and educational opportunities. Did Maria's life improve when she moved away from her home community? Explain.

/16

Respond in paragraph form (2-3 paragraphs) using the response criteria.

Write or type your answer below:

Mamihcimowewin !!!

